

Class Notes: Class Osteichthyes

Animal Kingdom • PU-I Biology • Class Notes

Bony Fish Features

Marine and freshwater habitats; bony endoskeleton, streamlined body with terminal mouth. Body covered by cycloid or ctenoid scales; respiration by four pairs of gills covered by operculum; air bladder provides buoyancy.

Reproduction and Examples

Heart two-chambered; poikilothermous; sexes separate, external fertilisation, mostly oviparous with direct development. Examples: Marine — Exocoetus (flying fish), Hippocampus (sea horse); Freshwater — Labeo (rohu), Catla, Clarias (magur); Aquarium — Betta (fighting fish), Pterophyllum (angel fish).